



“Our sustainability agenda is built on pioneering grain-to-glass sustainability, championing inclusion and diversity, and promoting positive drinking”

SRINIDHI RAO

HEAD, SUSTAINABILITY, DIAGEO INDIA



“The sustainability road map ensures that our business strategy is aligned seamlessly with the guidelines of the United Nations Sustainability Goals”

GAGANDEEP SETHI

SR VP, INTEGRATED OPERATIONS,
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ing operations. What's more, it has replenished more than 1.1 million cubic metres water across water-stressed sites, provided 264 sanitation units, and 13,000 litres per hour of clean drinking water across villages in Maharashtra, UP, Odisha and Rajasthan.

Diageo India has also taken steps to transition from fossil fuels and eliminated the use of coal in its fully owned distilleries by shifting to biomass and solar power. As a result, it has achieved a 93% reduction in market-based Scope 1 and Scope 2 greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions from 2020 to 2025; close to 99% energy used in direct operations comes from renewable sources. Scope 1 is direct GHG emissions from sources owned or controlled by the organisation. Scope 2 is indirect GHG emissions from generation of purchased electricity, steam, heat or cooling.

“Beyond our facilities, we are

driving climate resilience through community-based nature-based solutions. For instance, our Signature Packaged Drinking Water brand supports a large-scale mangrove restoration project in Puri, Odisha, where over 31,500 seedlings have been planted (mangroves are known to sequester carbon up to ten times faster than mature tropical forests),” says Rao.

Pernod Ricard India, the Indian arm of the French giant, has moved from coal to biomass at its largest distillery in Nasik. The parent company is globally the largest producer by volume and the second largest by value.

“The sustainability initiative has been taken at a global level under the platform of what we call ‘Good Times From a Good Place’. It is a well-articulated roadmap to ensure that our business strategy is aligned seamlessly with the guidelines of the United Nations Sustainability

Goals,” says Gagandeep Sethi, Senior Vice President of Integrated Operations, Sustainability & Responsibility, Pernod Ricard India.

The four elements of this platform are nurturing terroir, circular making, valuing people and responsible hosting. “By FY30, we aim to cut Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 54%, FLAG (forest, land and agriculture) Scope 3 emissions by 30.3%, and non-FLAG emissions by 25% across the group globally,” says Sethi. “This is an absolute reduction, while we will grow in volume. It is an ambitious target and India is playing a key role in helping us realise it,” he says, adding that Pernod Ricard is looking at reducing Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 90% for Pernod Ricard India and 54% for Pernod Ricard globally.

The company is increasing the use of renewable electricity and has signed a power purchase agreement with a green supplier. By 2030, 98% electricity used at all its plants will be renewable. This is in keeping with the group objective of using 100% renewable electricity for all plants globally by 2025, says Sethi.

Among other initiatives, Pernod Ricard India is moving rice-based Grain Neutral Spirit (GNS) to maize. GNS is a neutral-flavoured spirit distilled from different grains which is often used as a base for alcoholic beverages such as vodka and gin. “Maize has one-third the carbon footprint of rice. So, we have started moving towards maize and working with our suppliers to ensure they also make the switch to biomass in their distilleries. We are onboarding only those suppliers who have a greener energy source,” says Sethi.

Like Diageo India, Pernod Ricard India is reusing 20% of the bottles. It is using lighter bottles as well. Pernod Ricard India was the first to stop using mono-car-